

The Glorification of Our Bodies

Romans 8 Argues Our Freedom From the Old Will Into the New Inheritance

We have been spending considerable time in Romans 8. Paul acts as a lawyer, moving between the Old Testament, the old will, and the New Testament, the new will. From the foundation of the Old, he argues why we are free in the New Will that resulted in our inheritance.

To fulfill the Old Will, we all had to die in Christ. The old man had to pass away, the body of sin had to be destroyed, and a new creation had to rise in its place. That new man inherited sonship.

Paul's argument in Romans 8 is that all our freedom is based on the change of nature: from the nature of sin to the nature of life that was in Christ. Sin shall not have dominion over you, because you are not under law but under grace.

The law of the Spirit of life in Christ Jesus is now in me. The Spirit of life is my born-again human spirit, brought into life. The law radiating from that new nature says I am free from the nature of sin. The law of sin and death was the law radiating from my old spirit, saying I had a nature of sin and could do nothing else.

But the law of the Spirit of life in Christ Jesus has made me free from the law of sin and death.

The Holy Spirit Enforces What the New Creation Has Already Made Us

Romans 8 introduces the Holy Spirit when it says He bears witness with our spirit that we are God's children. Then Paul unveils the ministry of the Holy Spirit within the new nature:

"Likewise the Spirit also helpeth our infirmities."

Why "also"? Because something else already helps. My new nature freed me from sin. Now the Holy Spirit comes as the earnest of our inheritance, helping our weaknesses and our inability to produce results because of limitations imposed by the flesh.

We do not know how to pray as we ought under those limitations, but the Holy Spirit Himself makes intercession for us with groanings that cannot be uttered. He searches the heart, knows the entire mind of Christ, the plan of the Spirit, and is empowered to make intercession for us according to the will of God.

Because His will is being worked in our individual lives, we know all things begin to work together for good to those who love God and are called according to His purpose.

When Paul speaks of groanings that cannot be uttered, that revolves around the supernatural language given to us. It never ceases to amaze me how far God went to secure us as His purchased possession. He gave us the Holy Spirit, the earnest of our inheritance, to see that nothing is left undone.

Fifteen minutes of tongues cannot escape my mouth without some great mystery of God being uttered concerning my inheritance, His plan, His call, and my weaknesses.

The Will Is Fulfilled in Sons Who Have Actually Inherited

The will could only be fulfilled in us after our death, burial, and resurrection with Christ. The promise was fulfilled in Christ, and we had to die with Him so we could be resurrected with Him. Now the new will is fulfilled in the new man, in sonship and inheritance.

If I died and left you a million dollars and my house, you would possess the million dollars and the house. If someone asked where you got it, you would say, "There was a will, and I inherited it." You would be the beneficiary of that will.

So am I. I am an inheritor. I am a son of God. I am learning how to make good withdrawals. The Holy Spirit is the Lawyer explaining the will to me. The more He explains my will to me, the more of it I go and get from the enemy who has no right to it.

The more I understand the will, the more I appropriate, because it is mine.

Completed Adoption Makes Sons Approach by Inheritance

I understand a little about adoption because we adopted Daniel and Tawny. Daniel was adopted sight unseen while his mother was still carrying him. Tawny was adopted from the Philippines, and Rosalie stayed there for some time before bringing her home.

God asked me, "How does your oldest son come to you when he wants something?"

I said, "Strictly on inheritance."

He raids the refrigerator on inheritance. If he borrows money from me, it is not really borrowing. He does not stand outside the house yelling about his rights. He walks in because he knows his inheritance.

Then God asked me, "What would you do if Daniel and Tawny got their adoption papers out every time they wanted something from you as sons?"

It would take them a long time to sit down. If one of them, at seventeen years old, got out adoption papers to ask for something the other children can have, that would grieve me deeply. The adoption process was completed. Daniel and Tawny are bone of my bone, marrow of my marrow. They are my son and daughter.

Yes, there was a will, and that will was fulfilled in their adoption. They became mine.

I study the will in case there is something I have not received, something the devil is trying to keep from me. But when I go to get it, I go as a son.

The Spirit of Adoption Makes Us Children and Heirs

Romans 8:14 says:

"For as many as are led by the Spirit of God,
they are the sons of God."

As many as have been born again and are now led by the new nature instead of the nature of sin are the sons of God.

Verse 15 says:

"For ye have not received the spirit of bondage again to fear;
but ye have received the Spirit of adoption,
whereby we cry, Abba, Father."

The spirit of bondage again to fear was the spirit inherited from the first man Adam. It had the nature of sin in it, declared war on the mind, and forced men into sin even when they did not want to sin.

But we have received the spirit of adoption. My human spirit went from death to life. I no longer have the death nature deposited by the first man Adam; I have the new nature deposited by the last Adam. God adopted me out of the old family into His family, and He became my Father.

Then verse 16 introduces the Holy Spirit:

"The Spirit itself beareth witness with our spirit,
that we are the children of God."

His Spirit bears witness with mine that I am His child.

Joint Heirs Own the Inheritance Together With Christ

Romans 8:17 says:

"And if children, then heirs;
heirs of God, and joint-heirs with Christ."

If I am a child, then I am an heir. I am an heir of God the Father. Because I am an heir of God, I am a joint heir with Christ. I was quickened together with Him and seated in heavenly places in Christ Jesus. Jesus is the Firstborn among many brethren.

A joint heir does not mean half is yours and half is mine, unless the inheritance is divided. Joint heirship means what is His is mine, and what is mine is His. We own it together. We own healing together. We own the inheritance together.

The Holy Spirit is the Tutor of this inheritance. He searches the hearts, plural. He has time to search the heart of every person in the Body of Christ and still represent each one on an individual, streamlined basis before the throne of grace.

Anything you do not understand about the will, He first teaches you as it pertains to your freedom and conquest. Then He also knows your particular call in the Body of Christ and separates you to that call.

My oldest Brother already paid the bill. The Holy Spirit never sends me an invoice. He tutors me privately, and it seems as if all His attention is on my case. That is what makes Him God.

The Next Scheduled Stage of Adoption Is the Glorified Body

Romans 8:17 continues:

"If so be that we suffer with him,
that we may be also glorified together."

Then verse 18 clarifies the kind of suffering:

"For I reckon that the sufferings of this present time
are not worthy to be compared with the glory
which shall be revealed in us."

The glory to be revealed is the glory of the next stage of adoption: the glorification of the body. My spirit has already entered full adoption. It made me a child, an heir, and a joint heir with Christ. The next thing on the schedule is a glorified body.

Meanwhile, in my spirit, I have full sonship rights as an heir of God and joint heir with Christ to everything He promised for this life: health, provision, peace, and the weapons of warfare. The only reason I can be defeated is if I do not understand the will I inherited.

Jesus has already risen from the dead. As a joint heir, one resurrected body has been put on my account. I am scheduled to receive it.

Flesh and Blood Cannot Inherit What Only Grace Can Give

When I was born again, my spirit went from death to life. I was translated out of darkness into the Kingdom of His dear Son. It was not by works, lest any man should boast. It was inheritance, by grace.

The glorification of the body will be the same. In a moment, in the twinkling of an eye, this body will go from death to life. It will not be by your works.

First Corinthians 15 says:

"Flesh and blood cannot inherit the kingdom of God."

If this flesh and blood cannot inherit the Kingdom, then how could it be perfected into the Kingdom? Your spirit can be taken from glory to glory, and the more your spirit is taken from glory to glory, the more the new nature can be manifested. You can strip the flesh of its control, cleanse it of strongholds, and make it serve the spirit. But flesh and blood still cannot inherit the Kingdom.

It must wait for what already happened to the spirit by grace. One day, suddenly, we will be changed. The corruptible will put on incorruption, and we will be glorified.

The Present Body Can Serve, but It Still Carries Death

This body has death working in it. You fight harder every year. Natural hair turns loose. Diet and health products are everywhere because the flesh keeps looking for an easier way. "Can I just take a pill and go to bed? What do you mean, sweat an hour a day? What do you mean, change my eating habits?"

God indicated after the flood that man's days could be around one hundred twenty years. If anyone has lived that long, then the body can last that long. Much of what kills people is pressure. Pressure will kill you quickly.

I fight pressure like I fight sin. Why should I take pressure when God is behind me and I have His full inheritance? A moment of worry is a wasted moment. Refusing pressure gives longevity and keeps the mind clear.

This body can only be so perfected. In this state, it can serve my spirit and do what I command it to do because I have been born again. I can cleanse out strongholds and make it as good a servant as possible, but it still cannot inherit the Kingdom.

The Body Will Serve the Call Until Its Redemption

This body will serve you to the end of your call. Nothing can take you off this earth before your time. If God needs me in heaven, that is one thing, but even after finishing my course I would not mind staying around to teach the great-great-grandchildren.

It would be good for the Body of Christ to have testimonies of longevity that point to God. We have more to tap into than the world does. Start looking at the future as though you have time. At eighty-five, start a business if God tells you to. Do not say midlife and cut yourself short with your own words.

The only reason people are overturned and conquered is because they faint in their minds.

No Darkness Can Prevent the Ministry of Reconciliation

I get a kick out of people being afraid of things. How are you going to get someone in witchcraft saved if you are afraid to go talk to them? Who has the greater One?

When God said to separate from the world, He did not mean you could never enter the workplace or reach people in darkness. Paul clarified that, otherwise we would have to leave the world. He meant do not enter into fellowship with their deeds of darkness.

You can go into any dark place God sends you. You can go into a witchcraft hut, have them set you in the middle, march around you, burn things, and chant curses. When they untie you, get up and walk out. Nothing and no one can hurt you when God sends you.

If there are places we cannot be sent, how will the world be evangelized?

God left us here for the ministry of reconciliation:

"God was in Christ,
reconciling the world unto himself."

Now He is in me. That is why He left us here.

Creation Groans for the Manifestation of Redeemed Bodies

Romans 8:19 says:

"For the earnest expectation of the creature
waiteth for the manifestation of the sons of God."

What manifestation is Paul talking about? Verse 23 explains:

"And not only they,
but ourselves also,
which have the firstfruits of the Spirit,
even we ourselves groan within ourselves,
waiting for the adoption,
to wit, the redemption of our body."

All creation is waiting for the manifestation of the sons of God, the moment when the adoption process is completed in our bodies. Every created thing subjected to corruption through Adam's fall is groaning for redemption, for a new heaven and a new earth.

Creation was made subject to vanity, or corruption, not willingly, but because of the fall. God subjected it in hope of redemption in Christ. The whole creation groans and travails in pain together until now.

The manifestation of the sons of God is not the extreme doctrine some have called "manifested sons," as though believers never physically die and take over the world before glorification. That comes from misreading verses like these. The manifestation Paul is talking about is the redemption of our bodies and the restoration of creation.

The First Second of Glorification Will Outweigh a Lifetime of Suffering

Paul says:

"I reckon that the sufferings of this present time
are not worthy to be compared with the glory
which shall be revealed in us."

Seventy, eighty, or ninety years of suffering in this body cannot compare with the first second of glorification. Resisting sin, suffering persecution, living holy, fighting the good fight, telling the flesh to be quiet, enduring the labor of the call: none of it is worthy to be compared.

You may be called to live in a thatch hut, run up and down the Amazon, eat fish, and get people saved with no luxury, no exposure, and no applause. You may be imprisoned for your faith for thirty years and evangelize the prison. Still, one second after glorification will be worth more than a lifetime of suffering in this old body.

So gear yourself to win. The reward waiting in eternity is greater than anything the flesh can cost you.

We Groan From the New Nature While Waiting in Hope

We have the firstfruits of the Spirit, the first stage of the adoption process: the born-again human spirit. Yet we groan within ourselves out of that new nature, waiting for the adoption to be completed at the redemption of the body.

Why do we groan? Because to the right are nations at war and starving children. To the left is destruction on a world scale. Ahead is famine. Behind are threats of other powers. My spirit is imprisoned in a body still capable of sin, weakness, and weariness. It must be kept under subjection to the spirit.

I groan because I am tired of corruption and devastation. I groan for the adoption process, in creation and in my body, to be made complete. I am waiting for a body capable of serving the new creation I have been made, a body able to span heaven and earth, a body fit for the image of Christ.

Hope Waits With the Holy Spirit's Help

Romans 8:24-25 says:

"For we are saved by hope:
but hope that is seen is not hope:
for what a man seeth,
why doth he yet hope for?
But if we hope for that we see not,
then do we with patience wait for it."

We are saved in hope of the redemption of the body and the restoration of creation. We do not yet see it, so we wait with patience.

And look who He left us with while we wait:

"Likewise the Spirit also helpeth our infirmities."

The Holy Spirit helps our weaknesses in the waiting process. We do not know how to pray as we ought, but He makes intercession with groanings that cannot be uttered. He searches the heart, knows the mind of Christ, and makes intercession according to the will of God.

Therefore all things begin to work together in our personal lives for good, according to God's overall purpose.

Nothing Can Separate Us From the Love and Plan of God

Paul continues:

"For whom he did foreknow,
he also did predestinate
to be conformed to the image of his Son."

They had to wait in predestination until the Firstborn was born, because until then there was nothing to conform to. Whom He predestinated, He called. Whom He called, He justified. Whom He justified, He also glorified.

What shall we say to these things? If God is for us, what can be against us?

He that spared not His own Son, but delivered Him up for us all, how shall He not freely give us all things with Him? Who can lay anything to the charge of God's elect? It is God who justified. Who can condemn? Christ died, rose again, sits at the right hand of God, and makes intercession for us.

Who shall separate us from the love of Christ? Tribulation, distress, persecution, famine, nakedness, peril, or sword? No. In all these things we are more than conquerors through Him who loved us.

Paul said he was persuaded that neither death nor life, angels nor principalities nor powers, things present nor things to come, height nor depth, nor any creature can separate us from the love and plan of God being worked by the power of the Holy Spirit through our inheritance.